

QHT1

Business Management Tasks

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A furniture maker spends \$10,000 a year on prevention, \$15,000 on inspection, \$25,000 on internal rework, and \$70,000 on warranty claims. The plant manager just installed LED lighting. What share of its total cost of quality is failure cost?

- A. About 79%
- B. About 58%
- C. About 21%
- D. \$95,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A firm increases its prevention spending. Under the cost-quality relationship, what normally happens to failure costs and total cost of quality?

- A. Both rise, because better quality costs more.
- B. Failure costs rise.
- C. Failure costs fall, and total quality cost usually falls.
- D. Total quality cost always falls no matter how much is spent.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A call center logs complaints: long hold time 420, billing error 260, rude agent 90, dropped call 60, other 70. The center recently added a plant wall in the lobby. Using Pareto analysis, which categories should be tackled first?

- A. Rude agents, because that is the most serious complaint.
- B. Long hold time and billing errors, about 76% of complaints.
- C. Long hold time alone, since it is about 80% of complaints.
- D. All five equally, since every complaint matters.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A bottling line's control chart has limits of 498 ml and 502 ml. The last 25 samples all fall between 499 and 501 ml with no pattern. The supervisor, who just earned a Six Sigma certification, wants to adjust the machine after every sample to hit exactly 500 ml. What is the right call?

- A. Leave it alone; the process is in control, and adjusting for common-cause variation adds variation.
- B. Stop the line, because any variation is a defect.
- C. Widen the limits to 495 and 505 ml.
- D. Adjust after every sample to hit 500 ml.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which pattern signals special-cause variation even when every point is within the control limits?

- A. Points scattered randomly within the limits.
- B. None; points inside the limits always mean the process is in control.
- C. A single point near the center line.
- D. Seven or more points in a row on one side of the center line.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A hospital lab team wants to brainstorm all possible root causes of delayed test results across people, methods, machines, materials, measurement, and environment. The lab director has a new corner office. Which tool fits?

- A. A Pareto chart.
- B. A histogram.
- C. A control chart.
- D. A cause-and-effect (fishbone) diagram.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A plant manager plots machine age against weekly downtime hours for 30 machines, and the points rise together in a tight band. The machines were bought from three different vendors. What can be concluded?

- A. There is a negative relationship.
- B. There is a strong positive relationship; older machines tend to have more downtime, though the chart alone does not prove cause.
- C. Machine age causes downtime.
- D. The vendor is the cause of downtime.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A startup offers a cheap, simple accounting app aimed at freelancers who could never afford existing software. Its founders wear matching hoodies to every pitch. Established vendors dismiss it as too basic. What kind of innovation is this?

- A. Not innovation, because it has fewer features.
- B. Disruptive innovation.
- C. A radical technological breakthrough.
- D. Sustaining innovation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of sustaining innovation?

- A. A basic, low-cost product for people who buy nothing today.
- B. Any innovation from a large company.
- C. An established laptop maker adds a longer-lasting battery for its current premium customers.
- D. A new business model that later displaces the market leaders.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

After a new scheduling tool is piloted, 2.5% of staff sign up on day one. The next 13.5% sign up the following week after seeing the first results, and most staff are still waiting. The IT team designed the sign-up page in company colors. Which adopter category is the 13.5% group?

- A.** Innovators.
- B.** Laggards.
- C.** Early majority.
- D.** Early adopters.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A new cross-functional team has been together for three weeks. Members now openly argue about roles and whose approach to use. The team meets in a room with a view of the river. Which stage is the team in?

- A.** Norming.
- B.** Performing, because debate means high output.
- C.** Storming.
- D.** Forming.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team has agreed on roles and working norms, and cooperation is rising, but it is not yet working at peak independence. Which stage is it in?

- A.** Norming.
- B.** Storming.
- C.** Adjourning.
- D.** Performing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A furniture maker spends \$10,000 a year on prevention, \$15,000 on inspection, \$25,000 on internal rework, and \$70,000 on warranty claims. ~~The plant manager just installed LED lighting.~~ What share of its total cost of quality is failure cost?

Target word: failure share of COQ **Decides:** Failure = internal + external; total = all four.

A	Correct	$(\$25,000 + \$70,000) / \$120,000 = 79.2\%$.
B	Dropped element	Counts only external failure (70 / 120).
C	Inverted operation	That is the conformance share (prevention + appraisal).
D	Adjacent category	The dollar amount, not the share.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A firm increases its prevention spending. Under the cost-quality relationship, what normally happens to failure costs and total cost of quality?

Target word: direction of change **Decides:** Prevention reduces defects.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses the typical relationship.
B	Confusion set	Prevention lowers failures.
C	Correct	Defects prevented are cheaper than defects fixed.
D	Absolute language	Returns diminish; overspending is possible.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A call center logs complaints: long hold time 420, billing error 260, rude agent 90, dropped call 60, other 70. ~~The center recently added a plant wall in the lobby.~~ Using Pareto analysis, which categories should be tackled first?

Target word: vital few **Decides:** Two categories are 680 of 900 complaints.

A	Adjacent category	Pareto ranks by frequency, not perceived severity.
B	Correct	$(420 + 260) / 900 = 75.6\%$.
C	Wrong stem number	420 / 900 is about 47%.
D	Absolute language	Pareto focuses effort on the vital few.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A bottling line's control chart has limits of 498 ml and 502 ml. The last 25 samples all fall between 499 and 501 ml with no pattern. The supervisor, ~~who just earned a Six Sigma certification,~~ wants to adjust the machine after every sample to hit exactly 500 ml. What is the right call?

Target word: action on a stable process **Decides:** Only common-cause variation is present.

A	Correct	Tampering makes a stable process worse.
B	Absolute language	Some variation is normal and within spec.
C	Confusion set	Control limits come from process data, not preference.
D	Inverted operation	Tampering increases variation.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

Which pattern signals special-cause variation even when every point is within the control limits?

Target word: recognize a special cause **Decides:** Non-random patterns count.

A	Inverted operation	That is common-cause variation.
B	Absolute language	Patterns can signal special causes within limits.
C	Confusion set	Normal behavior.
D	Correct	A run like that is unlikely by chance.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A hospital lab team wants to brainstorm all possible root causes of delayed test results across people, methods, machines, materials, measurement, and environment. ~~The lab director has a new corner office.~~ Which tool fits?

Target word: tool choice **Decides:** Brainstorming causes by category.

A	Adjacent category	Ranks known causes by frequency; it does not generate them.
B	Confusion set	Shows the distribution of a single measure.
C	Confusion set	Monitors process stability over time.
D	Correct	Organizes possible causes into categories.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A plant manager plots machine age against weekly downtime hours for 30 machines, and the points rise together in a tight band. ~~The machines were bought from three different vendors.~~ What can be concluded?

Target word: interpret a scatter diagram **Decides:** Tight upward pattern between two variables.

A	Inverted operation	Both rise together, so it is positive.
B	Correct	Scatter shows association, not causation.
C	Confusion set	Reads correlation as causation.
D	Camouflage	Vendor was not plotted.

8. Answer B Concept 6

A startup offers a cheap, simple accounting app aimed at freelancers who could never afford existing software. ~~Its founders wear matching hoodies to every pitch.~~ Established vendors dismiss it as too basic. What kind of innovation is this?

Target word: innovation type **Decides:** Simple, cheap, for non-consumers, dismissed by incumbents.

A	Dropped element	Drops the new market it serves.
B	Correct	Starts at the low end or with non-consumers.
C	Adjacent category	Disruption is about the business model and market, not tech sophistication.
D	Inverted operation	Sustaining improves products for existing mainstream customers.

9. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

Which is an example of sustaining innovation?

Target word: work backward from type to example **Decides:** Better product for current mainstream customers.

A	Inverted operation	That is disruptive.
B	Absolute language	Company size does not decide the type.
C	Correct	Improves performance for existing customers.
D	Confusion set	That is disruption's outcome.

10. Answer D Concept 7

After a new scheduling tool is piloted, 2.5% of staff sign up on day one. The next 13.5% sign up the following week after seeing the first results, and most staff are still waiting. ~~The IT team designed the sign-up page in company colors.~~ Which adopter category is the 13.5% group?

Target word: adopter category **Decides:** The second wave, about 13.5%.

A	Adjacent category	The first 2.5%.
B	Inverted operation	The last 16% to adopt.
C	Confusion set	The next 34%, still waiting.
D	Correct	The 13.5% who follow the innovators.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A new cross-functional team has been together for three weeks. Members now openly argue about roles and whose approach to use. ~~The team meets in a room with a view of the river.~~ Which stage is the team in?

Target word: development stage **Decides:** Open conflict over roles and approach.

A	Confusion set	Norming comes after roles are agreed.
B	Inverted operation	Unresolved role conflict comes before performing.
C	Correct	Conflict over roles and methods marks storming.
D	Adjacent category	Forming is polite and tentative.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

A team has agreed on roles and working norms, and cooperation is rising, but it is not yet working at peak independence. Which stage is it in?

Target word: work backward from behavior to stage **Decides:** Agreed norms, not yet high autonomy.

A	Correct	Norms are set; performance is building.
B	Adjacent category	The conflict stage has passed.
C	Inverted operation	The ending stage, not a development stage.
D	Confusion set	Performing requires high autonomy, which is not yet present.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	10	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	1	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Cost-quality relationship	Spending on prevention and appraisal usually lowers failure costs by more, so total cost of quality falls as quality improves.	Believing higher quality always costs more overall.	Prevention, appraisal, internal failure, and external failure costs.
2	Pareto chart	Sort causes by frequency and focus on the vital few that account for most of the problem.	Treating all categories equally or ranking by severity.	Counts by category and “which to tackle first.”
3	Control chart and variation	Points within limits with no pattern reflect common-cause variation; adjusting for it (tampering) adds variation. Special causes show as points outside limits or non-random patterns.	Adjusting a stable process after every sample.	UCL, LCL, and a proposal to adjust.
4	Cause-and-effect (fishbone) diagram	A fishbone organizes brainstormed possible causes into categories such as people, methods, machines, materials, measurement, and environment.	Using a Pareto chart before causes are known.	“Brainstorm all possible root causes.”
5	Scatter diagram	A scatter diagram shows the direction and strength of a relationship between two variables, not proof of cause.	Reading a tight pattern as causation.	Two measured variables plotted against each other.
6	Disruptive vs. sustaining innovation	Sustaining innovation improves products for existing mainstream customers; disruptive innovation starts simpler and cheaper for overlooked or non-consumers and moves upmarket.	Equating disruptive with high-tech breakthrough.	A cheap, simple product dismissed by incumbents.
7	Diffusion of innovation	Adopters: innovators (2.5%), early adopters (13.5%), early majority (34%), late majority (34%), laggards (16%).	Mixing up innovators and early adopters.	Adoption percentages by wave.
8	Team development stages	Forming (polite, unclear), storming (conflict over roles and approach), norming (agreed norms), performing (high autonomy and output), adjourning.	Mistaking conflict for failure or for high performance.	How members are behaving toward each other now.

Course scope (public description): Business Management Tasks addresses important concepts needed to effectively manage a business. Topics include understanding the cost-quality relationship, using various types of graphical charts in operations management, managing innovation, and developing strategies for working with individuals and groups.